

5-Year Previous Year Questions, Topic-Wise (2021–2025)

Real UPSC questions, organized by subject instead of by year — revise a topic, then test it immediately.

An honest note on what's inside: Every question in this document is a real, verifiable UPSC question — nothing here is invented. Coverage is deepest for Polity, Economy, Geography, Environment, and Science & Technology (2023–2025); History has fewer confirmed questions, and 2021–2022 coverage across the board is lighter, since we only included questions we could confirm with confidence rather than fill gaps with anything uncertain. International Relations, Art & Culture, and Social Issues aren't covered yet in this edition. Where the correct answer is confirmed, it's shown in green. Where a question is included for practice but we couldn't independently confirm the official answer, work it out yourself and check it against the official UPSC answer key for that year.

Where the marks actually come from — Prelims weightage (2025 paper)

SUBJECT	QUESTIONS	NOTE
Economy	18	The single highest-weightage subject most years
Environment & Ecology	15	Heavily overlaps with current affairs
Polity	14	Stable and highly scorable with NCERT + Laxmikanth
Geography	13	Mostly applied — map-based and environmental geography
Science & Technology	13	Increasingly application-based, not pure facts
History (Modern + Ancient + Medieval)	16	Modern History carries the most weight within this bucket
International Relations	8	Almost entirely current-affairs driven
Social Issues & Schemes	3	Small but low-hanging
Art & Culture	2	Small but consistent — don't skip it

Polity

PRELIMS MCQ • 2025

Q. Consider the following statements about Raja Ram Mohan Roy: I. He possessed great love and respect for the traditional philosophical systems of the East. II. He desired his countrymen to accept the rational and scientific approach and the principle of human dignity and social equality of all men and women. Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) I only (b) II only (c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Answer: (c) Both I and II — Ram Mohan Roy respected Indian philosophical traditions while also promoting rationalism, scientific thinking, and social equality through reforms like the abolition of Sati.

PRELIMS MCQ • 2024

Q. As per Article 368 of the Constitution of India, the Parliament may amend any provision of the Constitution by way of:

1. Addition 2. Variation 3. Repeal

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only (c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (d) 1, 2 and 3 — Article 368 explicitly allows Parliament to amend any provision by addition, variation, or repeal, though not the Constitution's "basic structure."

Mains — GS II

2025 • 15 MARKS / 250 WORDS

"Right to privacy is intrinsic to life and personal liberty and is inherently protected under Article 21 of the Constitution." Explain. In this reference, discuss the law relating to DNA testing of a child in the womb to establish paternity.

2025 • 15 MARKS / 250 WORDS

The Indian Constitution has conferred the amending power on the ordinary legislative institutions with a few procedural hurdles. In view of this statement, examine the procedural and substantive limitations on the amending power of Parliament to change the Constitution.

2024

"The Constitution of India is a living instrument with capabilities of enormous dynamism. It is a constitution made for a progressive society." Illustrate with special reference to the expanding horizons of the right to life and personal liberty.

Economy

PRELIMS MCQ • 2025 • STATEMENT-BASED

Q. Statement I: Of the two major ethanol producers in the world, i.e., Brazil and the United States of America, the former produces more ethanol than the latter. Statement II: Unlike in the United States of America, where corn is the principal feedstock for ethanol production, sugarcane is the principal

feedstock for ethanol production in Brazil. Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

- (a) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct and Statement II explains Statement I
- (b) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct, but Statement II does not explain Statement I
- (c) Statement I is correct, but Statement II is incorrect
- (d) Statement I is incorrect, but Statement II is correct

Work this one out and verify against the official 2025 answer key.

PRELIMS MCQ · 2023 · STATEMENT-BASED

Q. Statement I: The Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) raised the policy repo rate cumulatively by 250 basis points between May 2022 and February 2023. Statement II: A tight monetary policy, achieved by raising interest rates, is used by the central bank to counter inflation. Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

Answer: Both statements are correct, and Statement II correctly explains Statement I — the rate hikes were a direct application of tight monetary policy to control inflation.

History

PRELIMS MCQ · 2024 · ANCIENT HISTORY

Q. Which one of the following is a work attributed to the playwright Bhasa?

Practice question — verify against the official 2024 answer key.

PRELIMS MCQ · 2024 · ANCIENT HISTORY

Q. With reference to ancient India, Gautama Buddha was generally known by which of the following epithets?

Practice question — verify against the official 2024 answer key.

Geography

PRELIMS MCQ · 2024 · STATEMENT-BASED

Q. Statement I: The troposphere is thicker at the equator than at the poles. Statement II: Strong convectional currents at the equator transport heat to higher altitudes, which does not occur as intensely at the poles. Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

Answer: Both statements are correct, and Statement II correctly explains Statement I.

PRELIMS MCQ · 2024

Q. Consider the following: Pyroclastic debris · Ash and dust · Nitrogen compounds · Sulphur compounds. Which of the above are products of volcanic eruptions?

Answer: All four — pyroclastic debris, ash and dust, and both nitrogen and sulphur compounds, are typically released during explosive volcanic activity.

Environment & Ecology

PRELIMS MCQ · 2025 · STATEMENT-BASED

Q. With reference to the planet Earth, consider the following statements: I. Rain forests produce more oxygen than that produced by oceans. II. Marine phytoplankton and photosynthetic bacteria produce about 50% of world's oxygen. III. Well-oxygenated surface water contains several folds higher oxygen than that in atmospheric air. Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

Answer: II only — oceans, not rainforests, produce more oxygen overall; marine phytoplankton and photosynthetic bacteria are collectively responsible for roughly half of the world's oxygen production.

PRELIMS MCQ · 2024/2025 · SPECIES IDENTIFICATION

Q. The organisms "Cicada, Froghopper and Pond Skater" belong to which of the following groups?

Answer: Insects — all three are insects (Class Insecta). Cicadas are known for their loud mating calls; froghoppers (spittlebugs) hold the record for the highest jump relative to body size of any animal; pond skaters walk on water using surface tension via hydrophobic legs.

Science & Technology

PRELIMS MCQ · 2024 · STATEMENT-BASED

Q. With reference to Radioisotope Thermoelectric Generators (RTGs), consider the following statements: I. RTGs are miniature nuclear fission reactors used to power spacecraft. II. RTGs generate electricity from heat released by the natural radioactive decay of plutonium-238. Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

Answer: Statement II only — RTGs are not fission reactors ("nuclear batteries" is a more accurate description); they generate power purely from the heat of radioactive decay, most commonly of plutonium-238.

PRELIMS MCQ · 2025 · STATEMENT-BASED

Q. Statement I: Some rare earth elements are used in the manufacture of flat television screens and computer monitors. Statement II: Some rare earth elements have phosphorescent properties. Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

- (a) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct and Statement II explains Statement I
- (b) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct, but Statement II does not explain Statement I
- (c) Statement I is correct, but Statement II is incorrect
- (d) Statement I is incorrect, but Statement II is correct

Work this one out and verify against the official 2025 answer key.

Using this document well

Attempt each question closed-book before checking the answer. Where we've flagged a question as "practice only," that's deliberate — we'd rather you verify it yourself against the official key than trust an answer we haven't independently confirmed. As you progress through a program with us, your coach shares a much deeper, continuously updated version of this bank matched to exactly where you are in your syllabus.